

P&C VISITS ...

Charlotte, NC

Low-key southern comfort with a touch of big-city buzz. That's Charlotte in a nutshell. Oh, yeah—it's extremely budget-friendly, too!



Latta
Plantation



Carolina
Raptor Center



King's
Kitchen



Discovery Place

HIGHLIGHTS

Historic Latta Plantation

A glimpse of early 19th-century life in the North Carolina back country. Lattaplantation.org

Carolina Raptor Center See eagles, hawks, and owls as you walk the trails of this nature center that helps heal injured raptors (birds that catch food with their feet). Carolinaraptorcenter.org

Discovery Place Incredible! The wild exhibits at this science museum (lie on a bed of nails, make music by stepping in light beams) are hands-on learning at its best. Discoveryplace.org

U.S. National Whitewater Center Have an adventure: try kayaking, rafting, or zip-lining. Go hiking or mountain biking for free; dog-friendly. Usnwc.org

ImaginOn Part library, part children's theater. Put on a play or watch one! Free to enter; some performances charge a fee. Imaginon.org

GOOD EATS

Big Daddy's Burger Bar Love the sweet potato fries. Gluten-free menu available. Bigdaddysburgerbar.com

Amelie's Two locations serve fabulous light French fare and organic coffee. Amellesfrenchbakery.com

King's Kitchen Simply fantastic soul food. All profits go to a local charity. Kingskitchen.org

Ritz-Carlton Charlotte

(RITZCARLTON.COM/CHARLOTTE)

Though it is a bit pricey, we just have to recommend this gem—it's the first LEED Gold-certified (super eco-friendly) hotel in the city. There's even a garden with beehives on the roof! It's very comfortable, very welcoming, and walking distance from a number of family-friendly hot spots. (Rates start at \$269 per night. Insider tip: Book your stay on a weekend when prices are actually likely to be lower, and watch for the special packages that frequently pop up on their website—prices sometimes drop to \$229 per night, including Thanksgiving this year.)



www.Scholastic.com/parents/letsgo Ten free things to do in Charlotte, NC